Yang Berbahagia Professor Emerita Datuk Technologist In-se-nieur Dr Siti Hamisah Tapsir
UCSI University vice-chancellor and president

Members of UCSI's top management team, esteemed deans and directors, dear graduands, proud parents and family members

Good morning, everyone. First of all, it's beyond an honour and a pleasure for me to be here to celebrate the Class of 2024. Thank you for the opportunity to be part of your big day!

Today, 999 freshly minted UCSI graduates have received their scrolls in the fifth and sixth convocation sessions of 2024, bringing the year's total to 3,907 graduates.

This makes the Class of 2024 one of UCSI's largest graduating cohorts. My heartiest congratulations to you.

You worked so hard and came so far to get to this moment. Today is truly your big day. And it is also a big day for your parents, family members, professors and friends.

All of them played a part in your success. They had your back, they stood with you and they never stopped believing - even when you did at times.

So, thank them, cherish them and never forget their love and support. Make sure you invite them to your party tonight. And no. They do not get to pay. Tonight, the bill is on you.

All of us at UCSI are extremely proud of what you have accomplished. We rejoice in your latest milestone. And we can't wait to see what all of you are going to do.

Dear graduates,

Before I close the final session of this year's convocation, I would like to reflect on the significance behind the conferral of credentials.

The scroll you hold in your hands comes with rights, privileges and responsibilities.

By earning your degree, you enjoy the right to better life chances. You earned the right to give the status quo a status update. And the right to chart your own path - your own legacy.

A great career awaits you, be it at one of the world's best companies or your own path-breaking enterprise.

This will naturally result in a variety of privileges. And while there is much to look forward to, I must stress that these rights and privileges also come with responsibilities.

The responsibility to apply your knowledge for the greater good. The responsibility to use your position to empower the less fortunate.

And ultimately, the responsibility to make this world a better place.

As UCSI alumni, you now take your spot in an ever-growing fraternity that brings people together from around the world.

They hail from more than 120 nations. They speak more than 70 languages. And they are reshaping society as changemakers in their own special ways.

We count among them, four Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia inductees. Three Prestige 40 Under 40 laureates. Malaysia's queen of pop. Prominent news anchors. Scientists, infectious diseases experts and public policy makers.

Now, the throwaway observation is that all the accounts I mentioned are all success stories.

But delve deeper and you will see that the common denominators of these accounts are faith, hope and love.

An abiding faith in humanity - that the underprivileged and underrepresented should have the right to make a decent living and enjoy equal access.

An audacious hope - a belief in things yet unseen. That people can rise up to be the change they are seeking for in the world.

And an abiding love that emphasises that we are our brother's and sister's keeper. That our destinies are indeed intertwined. A shared future where we rise and fall as one.

We see these virtues in the account of Kim Lim, Suzanne Ling and Lee Swee Lin - our three alumni who co-founded Picha Eats.

Empowering refugees to step up as food entrepreneurs, they have partnered with more than 40 chefs from Syria, Afghanistan, Palestine, Iraq and Afghanistan.

Since 2016, they have served over a thousand clients. And they have given more than RM5 million back to refugee families.

The same virtues are reflected in the story Alvin Teo - an alumnus who passed up many opportunities to work as a retail pharmacist.

Deciding to go where his help was truly needed, he signed up with Doctors Without Borders. And he has served with distinction in some of the world's most wartorn and famine-struck regions in Ukraine, Syria, South Sudan and Pakistan.

Class of 2024,

These are the stories that show how consequential a UCSI education can be. These are the stories that make humanity great.

I'm greatly encouraged to note how UCSI students have stepped up to be counted.

And like the alums I mentioned, all of you can make the telling difference. All of you have what it takes to make the world a better place.

So, never take anything - or anyone - for granted. Never be indifferent. Instead, be alive to the struggles of those around you.

Never hold back when help needs to be rendered. Never look the other way if you know something needs to be fixed - especially when you can fix it.

Lastly, never let your idealism grow cold. Constantly recalibrate your moral compass and abide by the time-honored values of audacity, integrity, perseverance and excellence.

Class of 2024, thank you for trusting UCSI with your education. Thank you for entrusting us with a very important chapter of your life.

It was our honour to have you here. And it is our great joy to see all of you graduating as fine young men and women who are ready to take on the world.

However near or far the winds of life may take you, you will always be part of the UCSI family.

So, remember us. And remember the many memories you made here, as you embark on exciting new journeys.

The University will be here. And if you want to inspire and nurture the next generation with us, just reach out.

We look forward to hearing many good things from you. And we wish you the very best in all your future endeavours.

Congratulations, Class of 2024!

Dare boldly, do greatly and make us proud in all you do!

I know you will.